

D626

Public Health Policy and Advocacy

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

In Country X, most hospitals are publicly owned, doctors are largely government employees, and care is paid for through general taxes. The country is famous for its public broadcaster. Which model does this describe?

- A. Out-of-pocket.
- B. Beveridge.
- C. Bismarck.
- D. National health insurance.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A country requires workers and employers to fund non-profit insurance funds, and patients see private doctors. Which model is this?

- A. Out-of-pocket.
- B. Beveridge.
- C. National health insurance.
- D. Bismarck.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

After a bill limiting flavored tobacco sales passes, the state health department, which moved to new offices last year, writes rules, trains inspectors, and begins retailer checks. Which policy stage is this?

- A. Formulation.
- B. Implementation.
- C. Agenda setting.
- D. Evaluation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Advocates hold press events and share data to get lawmakers to treat youth vaping as a problem that needs action. No bill exists yet. Which stage is this?

- A.** Adoption.
- B.** Formulation.
- C.** Implementation.
- D.** Agenda setting.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A widely covered drowning at an unfenced pool shocks a city. A pool-fencing ordinance drafted years ago is ready. A new council majority campaigned on child safety. The city also recently hosted a triathlon. Why is passage now likely?

- A.** The problem, policy, and politics streams have come together.
- B.** The draft ordinance is strong enough to pass on its own.
- C.** Public attention always leads to new laws.
- D.** The triathlon raised interest in water safety.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A county is weighing a proposal to widen a road through a residential area to six lanes. The road is named after a founding mayor. Which step best applies a health impact assessment?

- A.** Before the vote, estimate effects on air quality, injuries, and walking, and recommend changes.
- B.** Measure asthma rates five years after the road opens.
- C.** Study the history of the road's name.
- D.** Health departments should review only health programs.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A nonprofit health coalition, founded by retired nurses and funded partly by a federal grant, wants to urge state legislators to vote for a specific smoke-free housing bill. What rule applies?

- A. It may lobby within legal limits, using non-federal funds.
- B. Any use of funds is fine because this is advocacy, not lobbying.
- C. It may also endorse a candidate who supports the bill.
- D. Nonprofits can never lobby.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

During a measles outbreak, a state requires unvaccinated students to stay home. The governor is serving a second term. Under what authority does the state primarily act?

- A. Only the federal government may exclude students.
- B. State police power to protect public health.
- C. The governor's reelection mandate.
- D. The federal commerce power.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which public health action is most clearly based on federal rather than state authority?

- A. Licensing nurses in the state.
- B. Ordering a local isolation for a TB patient.
- C. Setting safety rules for food shipped across state lines.
- D. Requiring school entry vaccines.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A city adds a 2-cent-per-ounce tax on sugary drinks, with revenue going to parks. The measure passed by 58% after a long campaign. What kind of policy instrument is the tax?

- A. Direct provision of parks.
- B. Regulation, because it is a law.
- C. Fiscal (economic) instrument.
- D. Information.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which policy is an information instrument?

- A.** A subsidy for fruit at markets.
- B.** A ban on trans fats.
- C.** Required calorie counts on menus.
- D.** A city-run clinic.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

12.

Analysts compare two options to cut youth drownings. Option A (free swim lessons) has strong evidence, costs \$4 million, and faces no opposition. Option B (a fencing mandate for all backyard pools) has similar impact but costs owners \$30 million and faces strong opposition. Both were proposed at the same hearing. What should the analysis weigh?

- A.** Impact only.
- B.** Option B, because mandates always work better.
- C.** Neither, because both were raised at one hearing.
- D.** Impact, feasibility, and cost together, which favor Option A.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

In Country X, most hospitals are publicly owned, doctors are largely government employees, and care is paid for through general taxes. ~~The country is famous for its public broadcaster.~~ Which model does this describe?

Target word: system model **Decides:** Tax-funded and government-delivered.

A	Inverted operation	Patients pay directly.
B	Correct	Taxes fund care that government largely delivers.
C	Confusion set	Bismarck uses payroll-funded insurance funds and private providers.
D	Adjacent category	One public payer, but providers are private.

2. Answer D Concept 1 • transfer

A country requires workers and employers to fund non-profit insurance funds, and patients see private doctors. Which model is this?

Target word: system from description **Decides:** Payroll-funded insurance funds, private providers.

A	Confusion set	No insurance.
B	Inverted operation	Tax-funded, government-run.
C	Adjacent category	One government payer, funded by taxes.
D	Correct	Employer-employee sickness funds define it.

3. Answer B Concept 2

After a bill limiting flavored tobacco sales passes, the state health department, ~~which moved to new offices last year,~~ writes rules, trains inspectors, and begins retailer checks. Which policy stage is this?

Target word: stage **Decides:** Putting an adopted law into action.

A	Adjacent category	Drafting options came before passage.
B	Correct	Carrying out an adopted policy.
C	Inverted operation	The first stage, long past.
D	Confusion set	Evaluation measures effects later.

4. Answer D Concept 2 • transfer

Advocates hold press events and share data to get lawmakers to treat youth vaping as a problem that needs action. No bill exists yet. Which stage is this?

Target word: stage from activity **Decides:** Getting the issue noticed.

A	Inverted operation	Adoption means passing a policy.
B	Adjacent category	Drafting options comes after the issue is on the agenda.
C	Confusion set	Nothing has passed.
D	Correct	Making the problem a priority.

5. Answer A Concept 3

A widely covered drowning at an unfenced pool shocks a city. A pool-fencing ordinance drafted years ago is ready. A new council majority campaigned on child safety. ~~The city also recently hosted a triathlon.~~ Why is passage now likely?

Target word: why the window opened **Decides:** Problem, solution, and politics align.

A	Correct	Convergence opens a policy window.
B	Dropped element	A solution alone is not enough.
C	Absolute language	Attention without politics and a solution often fades.
D	Camouflage	Not the deciding factor.

6. Answer A Concept 4

A county is weighing a proposal to widen a road through a residential area to six lanes. ~~The road is named after a founding mayor.~~ Which step best applies a health impact assessment?

Target word: HIA use **Decides:** Pending non-health decision.

A	Correct	HIA informs a decision before it is made.
B	Inverted operation	Evaluation after the fact.
C	Camouflage	Irrelevant to health effects.
D	Adjacent category	HIA exists to bring health into other sectors.

7. Answer A Concept 5

A nonprofit health coalition, ~~founded by retired nurses~~ and funded partly by a federal grant, wants to urge state legislators to vote for a specific smoke-free housing bill. What rule applies?

Target word: lobbying rules **Decides:** Urging votes on a specific bill is lobbying; federal grants cannot pay for it.

A	Correct	Lobbying is allowed within limits but not with federal grant money.
B	Adjacent category	Urging a vote on a named bill is lobbying.
C	Inverted operation	Charities may not engage in candidate campaigns.
D	Absolute language	Charities may lobby within limits.

8. Answer B Concept 6

During a measles outbreak, a state requires unvaccinated students to stay home. ~~The governor is serving a second term.~~ Under what authority does the state primarily act?

Target word: source of authority **Decides:** State police power.

A	Inverted operation	School rules are largely state law.
B	Correct	States hold primary public health authority.
C	Camouflage	Political status is not legal authority.
D	Adjacent category	A federal power, used mostly for interstate matters.

9. Answer C Concept 6 • transfer

Which public health action is most clearly based on federal rather than state authority?

Target word: identify federal action **Decides:** Interstate commerce and spending.

A	Inverted operation	State licensing power.
B	Adjacent category	State or local police power.
C	Correct	Interstate commerce is federal.
D	Confusion set	State police power.

10. Answer C Concept 7

A city adds a 2-cent-per-ounce tax on sugary drinks, with revenue going to parks. ~~The measure passed by 58% after a long campaign.~~ What kind of policy instrument is the tax?

Target word: instrument **Decides:** Changes price.

A	Dropped element	Describes the revenue use, not the tax.
B	Adjacent category	The tax does not ban or mandate.
C	Correct	Uses price to shift behavior.
D	Confusion set	Labels and campaigns inform.

11. Answer C Concept 7 • transfer

Which policy is an information instrument?

Target word: identify information **Decides:** Informs rather than mandates or prices.

A	Adjacent category	Fiscal.
B	Inverted operation	Regulation.
C	Correct	Provides information for choices.
D	Confusion set	Direct provision.

12. Answer D Concept 8

Analysts compare two options to cut youth drownings. Option A (free swim lessons) has strong evidence, costs \$4 million, and faces no opposition. Option B (a fencing mandate for all backyard pools) has similar impact but costs owners \$30 million and faces strong opposition. ~~Both were proposed at the same hearing.~~ What should the analysis weigh?

Target word: criteria **Decides:** Impact is similar; feasibility and cost differ.

A	Dropped element	Ignores feasibility and cost.
B	Absolute language	Not always; cost and opposition matter.
C	Camouflage	The hearing detail does not matter.
D	Correct	Similar impact with better feasibility and lower cost.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	10	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	7	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	4	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Health system models	Beveridge: tax-funded, mostly government-run care; Bismarck: insurance funds financed by employers and workers, private providers; national health insurance: a single public insurer paying private providers; out-of-pocket: patients pay directly.	Calling any universal system Beveridge, regardless of who delivers care.	Who pays (taxes, payroll-funded insurers, one public insurer, patients) and who owns providers.
2	Stages of the policy process	Policy moves through agenda setting, formulation, adoption, implementation, and evaluation.	Confusing drafting options (formulation) with getting the issue noticed (agenda setting) or passing it (adoption).	What the actors are doing at this moment.
3	Multiple streams and policy windows	A policy window opens when a recognized problem, a ready solution, and favorable politics come together.	Believing a strong solution alone gets policy passed.	A focusing event, an existing proposal, and a political change at the same time.
4	Health impact assessment	A health impact assessment examines the likely health effects of a proposed non-health decision before it is made, and recommends changes.	Confusing it with evaluating a program after it runs.	A pending zoning, transport, or housing decision.
5	Advocacy vs. lobbying	Lobbying is urging action on specific legislation; charitable nonprofits may lobby within limits, may not campaign for or against candidates, and may not use federal grant funds to lobby.	Believing nonprofits can never lobby, or that general education is lobbying.	A nonprofit contacting lawmakers about a named bill, or funding sources for that work.
6	Federalism and police power	States hold primary police power to protect public health (quarantine, school vaccination rules, licensing); federal power works mainly through commerce and spending.	Assuming the federal government sets most day-to-day public health law.	Which level of government acts and under what authority.
7	Policy instruments	Governments act through regulation (rules and bans), fiscal tools (taxes and subsidies), information (labels and campaigns), and direct provision of services.	Calling a tax a regulation or a label a ban.	The mechanism the policy uses to change behavior.
8	Policy analysis criteria	Options are compared on public health impact, feasibility (political and operational), and economic and budgetary impact.	Choosing on impact alone while ignoring feasibility and cost.	Several policy options with different reach, support, and cost.

Course scope (public description): Public Health Policy and Advocacy prepares learners to approach public health in the political landscape. Policy can affect the health of groups ranging in size from individual organizations to entire nations and even the globe, making this an especially powerful and complex tool for the public health specialist. Learners in this course compare international healthcare systems, describe the policy-making process, evaluate a policy for its impact, and advocate in favor of a public health policy. There are no prerequisites for this course.